

Sean Pletz

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SUMMARY

HCI graduate student with a B.S. in Informatics and minors in Data Science, Computer Science, and Game Design. Experienced in user research, product design, prototyping, and technical development, with a focus on understanding user needs and translating insights into meaningful product experiences. Brings a multidisciplinary perspective across research, design, data, and technology.

EDUCATION

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

May 2026

Bachelor of Science, Informatics

Minors in Computer Science, Data Science, and Game Design

Cumulative GPA: 3.638/4.000

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

May 2028

Master of Science, HCI

PROJECTS

ESPN Fantasy Profiles

- Conducted user interviews and competitive analysis to identify user needs and opportunities for improving ESPN Fantasy profile experiences.
- Synthesized research findings into product requirements, UX recommendations, and Figma prototypes, presenting findings and proposed solutions to ESPN fantasy's UX team.
- Iterated on proposed experiences through usability testing and feedback, refining interactions and design decisions based on user needs.

Digital Fine Arts Marketplace

- Identified user needs and pain points through user testing with IU students around acquiring and exchanging fine arts course materials.
- Translated research findings into product requirements, user flows, and Figma prototypes, iterating based on usability feedback.
- Built the full-stack product, including database architecture and backend functionality using PHP and MySQL.

EXPERIENCE

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

August 2026 - Present

Assistant Instructor, Informatics Department

- Mentor student teams developing end-to-end prototypes for projects with Meta, Sony Playstation, and Twitch.
- Guide teams through problem definition, user research, requirements, prototyping, and iterative product development while providing feedback on workflows and design decisions.

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

January 2025 – May 2025

Teaching Assistant, Computer Science Department

- Led graduate and undergraduate lab sections for front- and back- end development for mobile applications in Swift and Xcode.
- Collaborated with professors and other teaching assistants to coordinate instruction and develop lesson plans.

Indiana University, Bloomington, IN

February 2024 – Present

Operations Lead

- Lead teams in organizing and managing sporting events, adapting plans to changing requirements and event needs.

SKILLS

Research: User Interviews • Usability Testing • User Research • Qualitative Analysis • Synthesis • Affinity Mapping

Design: Figma • Wireframing • Interaction Design • User Flows • Rapid Prototyping

Product & Technical: Python • C++ • JavaScript • HTML • SQL • PHP • MySQL • Git/GitHub • XCode